

SSL Offload:

HTTPS requests are more processor-intensive as compared to HTTP requests, which can impact system performance. Since the primary purpose of web servers is to serve pages quickly, SSL traffic can reduce their efficiency. SSL offloading helps ease this issue by removing the burden of encryption and decryption from the web server.

FortiADC SSL Offloading converts incoming HTTPS traffic into normal HTTP traffic, ensuring that backend web servers do not have to process SSL requests. A device is placed between the client-server connection to handle all SSL processing. In this case, Fortinet FortiADC serves as the intermediary, decrypting the client's request before sending it to the web server and encrypting the server's response before forwarding it back to the client. This method is known as "offloading" because all SSL processing is handled by FortiADC, resulting in resource savings for the backend web servers.

The only prerequisite for implementing SSL offloading is an SSL certificate for the domain. Additionally, FortiADC offers another advantage—it not only removes SSL processing loads from servers but also acts as a certificate manager. By storing all SSL certificates on the load balancer, it creates a single point for managing them efficiently.

